



National Archives and Records Administration

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Supplementary User Note

Relationship between HES Gazetteer Files with other Hamlet Evaluation System Files

Vietnam Special Studies Group (VSSG), 1971-1974

NN3-330-75-141

Records of the Office of the Secretary of Defense (Record Group 330)

When staff initially processed several of the Hamlet Evaluation System files, such as the Hamlet Evaluation System 1970 (HES70), Hamlet Evaluation System 1971 (HES71), and Vietnam Special Studies Group (VSSG), they noted the records contain the coded fields Corps (or Corps Region), Province, District, Village, and/or Hamlet, but in most cases only meanings for the Corps Region and Province codes were available. The records in the HES files also include UTM coordinates. Several years after receiving the HES files, the National Archives received three HES gazetteer files, Hamlet Evaluation System/Viet Cong Infrastructure (HES/VCI) Gazetteer, HES Gazetteer, and HES Gazetteer Source files, as part of the National Police Infrastructure Analysis Subsystem (NPIASS) I & II series (Record Group 472). The records in the gazetteer files include Corps Region, Province, District, Village, and/or Hamlet coded fields (which also makes up the United States Identification Number (USID number)); corresponding Province, District, Village, and/or Hamlet name fields; population numbers; ratings; and UTM coordinates.

According to the *Hamlet Evaluation System (HES) Command Manual*:

The HES Gazetteer was designed to provide an unclassified directory of hamlets and villages in RVN. The Gazetteer provides basic descriptive data for all hamlets and villages in the country that are included in HES. Data elements included are hamlet or village name, UTM coordinates, USID number, population by type, and the Administrative ID number. . .

The HES Gazetteer is widely used . . . as a source of information on individual hamlet locations and population. HES is the primary source of geographic data on RVN and, as such, provides much of the basic data for other MACCORDS automated systems and other monitoring systems. The Gazetteer provides the primary identification numbers for all geopolitical levels as well as geographic coordinates.¹

These statements indicate that the HES gazetteer files can be used in conjunction with the other HES files, along with other MACCORDS systems, and suggest that the HES gazetteer files are a possible source for the meanings for the District, Village, and Hamlet codes (USID number). In this regard, staff did a very cursory comparison of the UTM coordinates fields and the Corps Region, Province, District, Village, and/or Hamlet coded fields in about 20 records from the various HES files and the corresponding coded, name, and UTM coordinates fields in the HES gazetteer files. The staff's findings are as follows:

¹ Civil Operations and Rural Development Support, Research and Analysis Directorate, *Hamlet Evaluation System (HES) Command Manual*, Document No. DAR R70-79 CM-01B, Military Assistance Command Vietnam, 1 September 1971, pages 25 and 29, respectively. The *HES Command Manual* is available as supplementary documentation.

- In most cases the Province, District, Village, and/or Hamlet codes (USID number) and corresponding names, and UTM coordinates listed in the three gazetteer files are consistent with each other. In a few cases, there are codes, names, and UTM coordinates listed in only one or two of the gazetteer files. So while in general the codes, names, and UTM coordinates listed in the records may be consistent in all three files, the files do not contain all of the same records, which is confirmed by the differing record counts for each gazetteer file.
- The HES/VC Gazetteer and HES Gazetteer Source files list the corresponding GVN Province, District, and Hamlet names, and VC Province, District, and Village names for the USID number. Although, in some cases, no VC names are listed.
- The Corps Region and Province codes and names included in the technical documentation for some of the HES files match the Corps Region and Province codes and names listed in the HES gazetteer files.
- In general, the Corps Region, Province, District, Village, and/or Hamlet codes and UTM coordinates listed in the gazetteer files match the codes and UTM coordinates listed in the HES70, HES71, and VSSG files.
- The Hamlet Evaluation System Files (HAML A) 1967-1969 also contain the coded fields Country (or Corps Region), Province, District, Village, and/or Hamlet (USID number), but also fields with the corresponding Village and Hamlet names. In general, the codes and names listed in the HAML A records match the codes and names listed in the gazetteer files. However, the UTM coordinates do not match.

Therefore, researchers working with the HES files who are interested in obtaining the meanings (names) for the Province, District, Village, and/or Hamlet codes (USID number) may wish to consult the HES gazetteer files as possible sources for the code meanings. Other Department of Defense Vietnam War-related data files in NARA's custody, such as the People's Self-Defense Force Management Information System (PSDF/MIS), may also contain USID numbers, corresponding names, UTM coordinates, and/or information extracted from HES.

Lastly, there are some questions regarding the UTM coordinates listed in some of the HES files. In the early 1990s, two researchers reported that the UTM coordinates in the HAML A files were insufficient for their purposes because the records did not identify the particular map sheet on which each hamlet or village appeared. The researchers indicated that three different UTM map sheets covered the Republic of Vietnam and there is a 5° overlap in the UTM map sheets. They also mentioned that in the course of their research, they discovered that at some point the UTM coordinates in the HES Gazetteer had been transformed to latitude-longitude coordinates. The available record layouts for the HES gazetteer files do not include fields for latitude-longitude coordinates nor do the sample dumps for the HES gazetteer files show latitude-longitude coordinates data. The HES gazetteer files in NARA's custody appear to only contain UTM coordinates.

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